Python Code Style

Last modified: 2026-11-04 11:00:20 (PST)

Base guide

The lab's Python style is an amendment of Google's Python style guide, read in the lab's fork at a pinned commit. Follow that guide for everything the amendments below do not change. Google's current wording is at google.github.io/styleguide/pyguide.html.

Amendments

Linting and formatting with Ruff

Ruff replaces the pylint configuration and the Pyink formatter that Google's guide mentions. It lints and formats in one tool.

- Lint settings live in the lab's `python/ruff.toml` in the `Morrison-Lab/psc` repository. Copy it to the root of a repository as `ruff.toml`.
- Line length stays at 80 characters, as in Google's guide.
- Docstrings follow Google's format.
- Rule families are pycodestyle, pyflakes, isort, pydocstyle, pyupgrade, bugbear, comprehensions and simplify.

CI runs the checks and fails on any finding.

No nested function calls

The lab's no-nested-calls rule applies to Python. Give each intermediate result a name. Method chaining is fine. Ruff cannot check this rule, so it is not yet enforced.

Planned work

- Lint the Python chunks in `.qmd` files with the same configuration.
- Run the checks through `Morrison-Lab/gha`'s `check-python-package` workflow in every repository that contains Python.
- Open an issue when upstream changes Google's guide.

These are tracked in #90.